



Important information for visits to the German Bundestag

Your invitation to visit the German Bundestag is based on the Bundestag's calendar of sittings, which is planned well in advance. It may therefore be necessary for us to **reschedule or cancel** your visit at short notice.

If it is necessary to make changes to the programme on the day of your visit, you will be informed about this by the staff of the Visitors' Service at the west portal of the Reichstag Building or the west visitors' entrance of the Paul Löbe Building. They will also be happy to answer any questions you may have.

Visitors' programmes are always held for several groups together. It is therefore absolutely essential that you **arrive punctually** out of consideration for other visitors, as places reserved on the gallery or in the discussion rooms cannot be kept indefinitely. If you arrive late, you must expect to wait for a considerable time and in certain circumstances your programme may be changed or certain elements may be cancelled.

The Internal Regulations of the German Bundestag and the Rules on Entry to and Conduct in the Bundestag's Buildings

(https://www.bundestag.de/regulieren_hinweise_antrag_zutrittsberechtigung) apply throughout the premises of the German Bundestag. Please be aware in particular of Annex 2 of the above rules. This contains a list of items that **may not be brought into** the buildings when visiting the German Bundestag. In addition to **weapons** and **dangerous objects** such as knives, these also include certain tools, whistles, bottles, irritant gas or pepper sprays and laser pointers.

As X-ray equipment is used for the **security checks**, we request that you avoid bringing metal items into the Bundestag's buildings wherever possible.

Every visitor (aged 16 or over) must carry a **valid official photo ID (identity card or passport)** with them. Young people aged 14 or 15 should carry an identification document (student ID card, passport or similar document with their name and a picture on it).

Leaders of visiting groups have an obligation to inform their groups about these regulations and to ensure compliance with them as necessary. They must present their letter of confirmation and be able to identify the individual members of their group during the security checks on entry.

Coats, umbrellas, bags, tape recorders, binoculars and similar devices must be **handed in at the cloakroom** before you go onto the visitors' gallery for a lecture or to watch a plenary sitting. No facilities are available for the storage of suitcases or other luggage. **Mobile phones must be switched off.**

Under Rules 4 and 5 of the Internal Regulations of the German Bundestag, **peace and order must be maintained in the Bundestag's buildings**. Visitors must show **consideration for the work of the Bundestag**. They must refrain from all actions likely to disturb the activities of Parliament, its

bodies, organs and institutions. **Applause and expressions of disapproval are forbidden** on the galleries

In particular, the bringing of material and objects that feature content which is racist, xenophobic, glorifies violence, is discriminatory, antisemitic or extremist is prohibited. This ban also applies to the wearing of clothing or accessories featuring slogans or symbols making similar statements. This rule is in keeping with the requirement to respect the dignity of the House, as per Rule 4(1) of the Internal Regulations.

The sale of goods (with the exception of goods sold by the tenant businesses) and collections are not permitted. With the exception of guide dogs, animals may not be taken into the buildings of the German Bundestag. It is also not permitted to unfurl banners or to display or distribute information materials.

If tour guides give their permission, photographs may be taken during **guided tours** provided by the Visitors' Service in the Reichstag Building and other premises of the German Bundestag and during **lectures** on the visitors' gallery; **photographs may be taken only for personal** and not commercial **use**. Visitors attending **plenary sittings must hand in film and photographic equipment** beforehand.

Sittings of the German Bundestag are open to the public. Cameras **film** (and record audio) during the plenary sittings. In addition, photos are taken (including by press representatives in attendance). **This also applies to the visitors' gallery on the plenary chamber.** The **audio-visual material** is **broadcast live** on television and online and is also **stored (published)** online where it is freely accessible. By **entering** the buildings of the German Bundestag, the **leader of the visiting group** declares that they, along with all members of the group, **agree to photos and audio-visual recordings being taken of them** during their visit to the German Bundestag, and subsequently being **published**.